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Seminar/ Workshops

Design & Deliver...

Background

Public Speaking Objective: 'To position the speaker favourably in the mind of the audience; such that they would seek or confirm their decision to have that speaker deliver strategic services to their business'.

The best way to approach the development of any public speaking engagement is to think in terms of 'Design and Deliver'. A great Design makes the Delivery easy, and visa versa. Many presentations suffer the fate of poor delivery by way of poor design; don't let your presentations 'go down this road'...

Make time available for preparation; your audience will notice the difference and you'll achieve your speaking objectives with ease. Use the following notes as your guideline and as always, if you get stuck, give your advisor-e coach a call...

Good Luck!

Design

1. Identify your target audience.
2. Define the desired outcomes in writing. This will force you to be clear in your approach and content.
3. Summarise the desired outcomes into **(principles)** and then select the single **(concept)** that best describes the content you want to cover in that session/workshop or boot-camp.
4. Once you've identified the **concept**, break it into **principles** which then break down into **(detail)** per **principle**. Try to limit the **detail** to 3 key points per **principle**.

The above design format is known as the **C**.**P**.**D** hierarchy or '**Concept** – **Principle** – **Detail**'.
As an example...

Concept Scuba Diving Safely.

Principles
1. Being physically fit to dive.
2. Using the best equipment you can afford.
3. Knowing your dive area.

Detail
Being physically fit to dive.
Be able to run a sub 4 minute mile and why/how...
Be able to complete 400 push ups and why/how...
Be able to get wetsuit over beer-pot and why/how...
3 Points of **Detail** – per **Principle**.

Design

- Remember, ‘the brain can only absorb what the backside can endure’ so try to break it into chunks that will encourage people to get up and move around if you have a lot to cover. If you want ‘energy’ in the room, the easiest method is to direct the audience to “turn to the person next to you and discuss ‘x’ for 45 secs – go!” (Remember to be strong in your direction)

- Each segment or **Principle** should explain how it relates to the **Concept** and why it’s important before delivering the **detail**. The **detail** points (ideally 3) should then be summarised before spelling out the “where to from here” action steps. This needs to occur throughout the programme so all the **principles** relate to an active involvement in the learning.

- If you’re planning a workshop or programme that extends into a full day (or more) then think of your day in terms of ‘Modules’. Each module has its own C.P.D structure but each Concept must in turn, fit within an overarching theme. (You might find it easier to plan your content order/ speakers around morning tea/ lunch /afternoon tea breaks

- The information should relate equally well to Pragmatists (require proof – facts and figures, testimonials or case studies) Reflectors (need time to ‘think it over’ so direct them to take a moment and write down their thoughts) Theorists (like to be asked for their input, need to understand why and how before moving to the next point) and Activists (keep it energising and exciting, be actively involved and ‘get their hands on it now’)

Design Summary Table

Fun or 'Team Building' sessions may require a more relaxed structure. In this case use the {Content / Why/ Remember} framework.

Target Audience	
Desired Outcomes	

Presenter (Order)	Concept or Content. (Story/Exercise)	Principle or Why You're Presenting This Content	Detail or - Key Points You Wish Them to Remember
Presenter			
Presenter			
Presenter			

Agenda Table (Presentation Order/ Run Sheet)

Activity	Time	Principle 1. (Content)	Principle 2. (Why)	Principle 3. (Remember)
Arrive & prepare	8am -8.30am			
Meet & Greet (coffee available)	8.30 – 8.50			
Wkshp starts M.O.C	9am – 9.15			
Spkr 1	9.15 - 10.30			
Morning tea	10.30 – 10.45			
Spkr 1 recommences	10.45 – 12.30			
Lunch	12.30 – 1pm			
Spkr 2 starts	1pm – 2.30.			
Aft tea	2.30 – 2.45			
Spkr 3 Starts	2.45 – 3.45			
Wkshp ends. M.O.C	3.45 - 4.00pm			

M.O.C = Master of Ceremonies / 'MC'.

Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5	Week 6	30 days later
Ensure all current activity is loaded into the call plan for final target assessments.	'First' Invitation letters/cards for targets, and existing clients are to be merged and posted. (Hardcopy) 'Second' Invitation email drafted ready to go as is the Follow up Phone Script and text message as well as the 'Can't wait to see you' email.	'First' Invitations (hard copy) should be received by invitees	Beginning of week, 'Second' invitation email should be received by invitees.	Send "Can't wait to see you" email to all invitees that have accepted reminding them of the session they have chosen, clear directions on how to get there, the time they are expected, who they can call if they get lost or are unable to make it 'last minute', what is provided ie b'kfast or nibbles and their "lucky draw" number for dinner at a restaurant etc. This should be a 'personal reminder' from the Seminar Coordinator and the email should require their confirmation of being read.	Final reminder text message sent to cell phones.	Post out the "Chocolate Fish" or whatever is used as a metaphor for the theme of the seminar series, with a small note saying you'll be in touch...
Ensure all centres of influence are in agreement and have identified their representative and initial selection of attendees.	Centre of influence invitations (co branded if in agreement) are to be merged and posted	Record the names of clients and targets that have R.S.V.P'd in the attendee registrar.	Phone centre of influence contacts to gain confirmed names of their attendees	Send confirmation to centres of influence of their invited attendees (for their sessions only) and a list of confirmed targets and existing clients, as agreed.	Session Dates Put on a show!	
Select a date for the workshop then ensure all venues are secured and confirmed. **Appoint telemarketing firm with text message capability.**	Develop attendance registrar which includes correct spelling of the name of person/s accepting, the name of their business and its physical address, phone number (pref' cell #) email address and session they wish to attend.	Presenters are to meet to compare thoughts and 'test' their 'anchors' as they have prepared thus far. Videos or 'comedy breaks' are to be discussed and identified at this time. Exact clarity around who is covering what should now be established.	Phone to ask key clients and targets if they will be in attendance. (Delegate to Seminar Coordinator who will be present at the sessions or appointed telemarketer) Record in attendee registrar.	Have majority of name stickers, handout packs and seminar feedback forms printed, packaged and ready to go.	Send "Thank you for your attendance" email and advise of future contact ideas. Include names and contact phone numbers of presenters with small photo and topic covered.	
Determine who is responsible for the supervision of attendee invitations and confirmations	Develop initial CPD Structure Table (Concept, Principles, Detail) for all presenters in alignment with metaphor.	Second Invitation (email) should now be merged and sent to invitees.	First full length rehearsal for all presenters.	Second and final full length rehearsal for all presenters.		
Reach agreement on invitation style and wording. All parties "Sign off"	Provide the centre of influence representatives with a copy of the Seminar bullet points to make it easier for them to 'pre-sell' clients.					
Price and agree on metaphor gift for seminar series. Could be a chocolate fish or a blindfold?						

(Broad) Timeline

July (as an example)				
Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5
		Commence Individual Fee Growth Plans		Fee Growth Plans Completed
August				
Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5
Develop Concept Domains & Associated Service Offers	Commence Singular Approach to Existing Clients to Secure Lite Fundamentals Engagements	Commence Design of Communication Plan	Archive all Existing Promotional Videos & Quiz Links	Finalise Communication Plan
September				
Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5
Approach COI's with Seminar Concept & Secure Agreement to be Involved	Send a few invites to 'Friendly' clients for the 'testing session'	Build CPD Structure for Seminar – Begin Collation of Material		Run 'Testing Sessions' (Power Lunch as an example) to gain reaction to Seminar Content
October				
Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5

(Broad) Timeline

November				
Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5
		Do first 'Dry Run' internal rehearsal of Seminar Content		
December				
Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5
Do second rehearsal of Seminar Content				
January				
Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5
				Do third rehearsal of Seminar Content
February				
Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Week 4	Week 5
			Run Seminar	

Delivery Styles (and when to use them)

Call to Action & Close

Let your 'body of work' do the selling.

(Your invitation for them to take up your service should feel like you're inviting good friends to a special dinner)

- Coach & Collegiate Delivery style
- Facilitate Options & Consequences
- What If/ What's Next frame

Deliver

Teach them with caring; be enthusiastic without being condescending.

- Educator Delivery style
- Practice, Skills, Information
- Common Sense Learning
- How Frame

Connect & Engage

Still being 'you'; just a bigger 'you'.

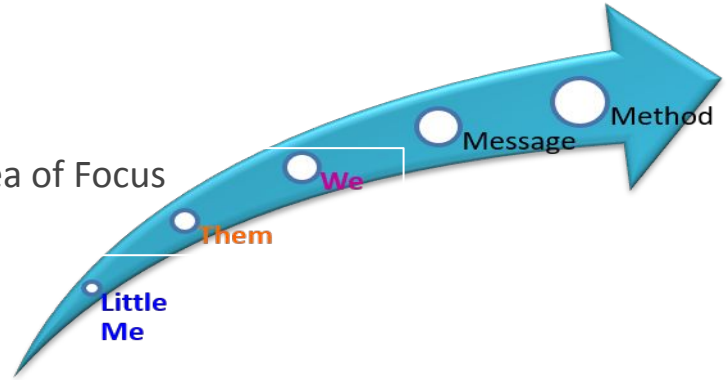
- Motivator Delivery style
- 4 Values W.I.I.F.M
- Why Frame
- (Why This, Why Now, Why You, Why Me)

Position & Set the Scene

Strong, Confident & Unwavering; not arrogant.

- Coach Delivery style – Voice of Authority
- Relate Concept & Agenda
- What Frame (How you work together today)

Your Area of Focus



Delivery Styles (and when to use them)

Coaching	Presenting	Facilitation
Participants are present to develop a specific skill or behaviour	Audience is present to receive information / instructions.	Participants are present to combine their skills and knowledge within a team environment to solve problems or develop new initiatives and beliefs.

Characteristics	Characteristics	Characteristics
Participants are expected to apply what they have learnt in a practical sense, upon completion of their coaching.	Participants are expected to act upon the information provided upon completion of the presentation.	Participants are expected to reflect and further develop the team plans.
Coaching plans are developed to impart specific information and aid learning.	Presentation plans are based upon what is to be communicated. It's effectively content based.	The facilitation plan is generally agenda driven in order to structure the process of team development.
Observation and / or Demonstrations are used to explain key facets of content.	Logical structure is used to explain key facets of content.	Key points to be determined are outlined by the facilitator.
Experiential learning (involvement) is used to share learning amongst members present and retain interest and attention.	Presenter generally answers rather than asks questions.	Facilitator asks questions with a strong emphasis on soft fact questions. (opinions) Engage the attendees in contemplation of the issue.
Training aids such as tapes, case studies, videos, role play and team activities are used to illustrate critical learning points.	Data, charts, graphs and models are used to support the message. (Relating to the pragmatist)	Effective facilitation is supported by a range of techniques and problem solving processes.
Coach asks questions or observes behaviour to determine the rate of learning achieved.	The rate of learning is often determined by volunteered feedback or a feedback questionnaire.	The learning achieved by the team is monitored by feedback, formal and informal.
Number of participants should generally be no more than 1 coach to 10 pupils.	Group can be any size.	Ideal group numbers is between 5-9 depending on compatibility of skill and experience.

Delivery Styles (and when to use them)

There are generally four types of 'Theme' used when communicating. Each theme comprises a mixture of tone, pace, content and non-verbal communication methods. You may 'jump' from one to other depending on your presentation, the trick is to be consciously aware of which theme you use and when/why.

Educator		**Motivator**	
	Think back to your years in school / university. How did the teacher generally pass the information? Was it more mono-tone, less inviting of input, in many cases with the teacher's back to the class as they wrote on the board? Generally the delivery is more content based rather than feeling based.		**A motivator style (as the name suggests) is more rapid in verbal pace with more vivid non-verbal gestures. They tend to be strength positions rather than submissive with more frequent calls to action however, you'll note the calls often involve the "royal we" as in many cases, the relationship between speaker and audience is not close at an individual level.**
Coach		**Collegiate**	
	Despite the many coaching models used to 'give feedback', most coaches have earned the right to be direct and instructional during key moments. The tone is more 'guttural' and power based to help provide confidence in the instruction and achieve immediate action. A strong relationship has been established or at least a hierarchy position has been accorded the coach.		**This is two workmates relaxing and sharing a problem or opportunity. Both have equal standing in terms of hierarchy positions and each are willing contributors even if one is more skilled or knowledgeable about the current topic. Softer tones and non-verbal language are used.**

There are two critical components for developing powerful presentations;

1. Design
2. Delivery

The 'Evolution Process' will see you starting with the design component first, with the delivery rehearsal providing insights into 'feel & audience connection'. There are no shortcuts, just follow the 'get it down then get it good' philosophy or you risk 'writers block'.

Delivery

1. PSYCHOLOGICAL PREPARATION

- What is your intent?
- Are you present in the moment, is your ego in 'check'?
- Summon the appropriate level of energy for your audience and content.
- Make sure your tone, pace, posture and facial expressions match each stage appropriately.

2. CONNECT WITH THE AUDIENCE

- Start strong but not necessarily loud. It's all about connection!
- Physical stance and posture of confidence. (Professional not arrogance)
- Voice tone of Authority (From your diaphragm not back of throat)
- Connect with audience via Universals, Truisms or Calling out the ghosts.

Universals are a common or shared experience that everyone can relate to such as frustration with the traffic or sports team. Truisms are indisputable facts verifiable in the here and now such as "We're sitting in this beautiful hall in Fiji"

Calling out the ghosts is when you preempt negative thoughts and feelings that you think your audience may hold regarding your presentation. Such as, "Some of you may be wondering about the upcoming price rise that's been rumoured to be happening, we'll be covering this in detail this morning…"

Delivery

3. HONEY & MUMFORD RELEVANCE STATEMENT.

- In the positive sense, state how your concept relates to them and their lives/business in a W.I.I.F.M type statement. Support the statement by appealing to pragmatists, reflectors, activists and theorists in their language.

Such as,

"If you're a professional, your career is defined by your ability to prospect upwards and secure client engagements so today's sales workshop is all about enhancing your ability to sell your ideas to your clients in a way that increases your credibility and provides a platform for positive business relations."

Support

In fact, a recent study by Harvard Business School found that past graduates that were comfortable and competent in selling their professional services made partner on average, 3 years earlier than their colleagues and on average, earned up to nine times the revenue of their lesser sales skilled peers.

Technical ability made little or no difference to income earning potential once graduates had made partner. Turn to the person next to you and discuss this for a moment…"

Delivery

4. DESCRIBE THE CONCEPT OR 'OVERALL THEME'.

- Example - "This boot-camp can be defined as winning business because it's all about positively achieving new business for you and your practice".
- Explain the background, how you came to be here today...

5. COMPLETE YOUR SELF INTRODUCTION.

- Professional and personal perspective. Keep it relevant, punchy and brief. Any longer than 1 minute will start to sound egotistical. They'll get a chance to learn more about you from stories and information shared throughout your presentation.

6. SET THE SCENE

- Establish the guidelines for how things work. Explain what's expected of them, how they should engage with you (presenter) and other attendees. Perhaps introduce the 'PARK' board if need be.

Delivery

7. LAYOUT THE AGENDA

- What will be covered – when.

8. GO TO WORK!

- Deliver the principles and detail in a manner that engages the audience (3 way) from outset.
- You to Audience / Audience to Audience /and Audience to you.
- Use stories, activities, humour, visual aids, reveal your content don't just dump it on them, encourage brief notes and reflection time, draw attendees that would otherwise choose to be silent at the back of the room, challenge their thinking within defined boundaries.
- The best way to judge the mood of the room is by their involvement with you and the easiest way to connect with an audience that is proving difficult, is to get them to connect with each other. The simple act of creating noise in the room will lift the emotional connection of the attendee to your content. (Provided it's relevant).

Additional Points to Remember

- Define the objective in writing. This will provide guidance over many of the tactics used in both organising and presenting the material.
- Always capture the attendee details prior to the seminar. In the event that you open the seminar to 'the general public on the night', be sure and have a registration book and name tag 'station' as they enter.
- Make sure the venue matches the theme of your presentation. If you're trying to 'wow them' don't use the cheapest nastiest venue. Spend what's appropriate and send a better message. (See light and sound notes at bottom)
- If you use an existing client as a guest speaker, make sure they are properly introduced. Explain how their experience relates to the concept of your presentation, why you've asked them to participate and their level of involvement following the event. (ex- "They will be happy to answer any questions you have tonight but if you think of something you want to ask them later on, please direct all enquiries via our office")
- The 'Master of Ceremonies" type role should cover things like the introduction of the agenda, planned breaks and rules regarding refreshments, where toilets can be found, cell phones off etc. (housekeeping). These topics should not be covered by the 'platform speaker'.

Additional Points to Remember

- All staff in attendance need be acutely aware of their roles at the seminar. Be absolutely specific about who does what and practice the art of engaging. Remember, approaching people after a seminar or at a trade show is not easy, you need to be prepared as the time lost while you 'build confidence' means opportunity has already walked out the door. If other professionals are in attendance, with your knowledge in advance, it's a good idea to recognise them at some part (positively) throughout the seminar.
- Make sure the call to action is clear. This needs to be rooted at the heart of the design of your presentation.
- Make sure the hand-outs have your full contact details and names of presenters (and their topic covered) at the front or back of the hand-out. Always make sure you have more than you need to allow for those that want to 'take one for a friend'.
- Where budget allows, provide refreshments of some sort. They 'slow the pace' of the attendee making it easier to engage with them prior to and after the presentation. All speakers should make a point of meeting people both prior and after. (Especially prior, it helps you get into 'state' and may even provide valuable information about your target audience)

Additional Points to Remember

- If you're opening a session with additional speakers as part of your presentation, be sure to make mention of them in your (framing) 'setting the scene'. Let the audience know how their information will relate to your content and vice versa.

- If you're 'second or third' etc. in line, you won't need to frame in as much detail (and be wary of over-playing the 4 values w.i.i.f.m. back to back) as the first presenter, but you will still need to capture their attention. If you're going to use a story also, try to link it to the previous material or opening story somehow even if it's a stretch. (ex- "The story of the exploding jet pack reminds me of a situation I heard of recently. Whilst it doesn't involve alcohol or explosives, it does involve people who were confused about what they were doing and where they were going, kind of like the 62.yr old guy in his shed. Thought he was headed towards stardom but in fact, he was headed to the A&E…)

- 'Middle' presenters need to link their material to the first and again, introduce those presenting after them. Remember, the link doesn't necessarily need to be direct so don't get frustrated just because the topics are varied.

Additional Points to Remember

- ‘End’ presenters need to relate to the previous presenters but make sure they inform the audience of what they can expect going forward, in their close. Tell them you intend to run more sessions in future, that you intend to follow them up but not to feel pressured, (you’re doing it because you know people get busy, not to be a nuisance) Summarise the Concept by re-telling the audience about the 4 (or whatever number) key principles you want them to remember (as bullet points only)

- All the material should relate by virtue of the “Concept – Principles – Detail” which is in your original construction and design. If you’re not sure what each person is doing in this regard, make sure you get a single page layout showing each person’s Principles and Detail before you go too far in your preparation.

- Remember; focus on design first, delivery second.

Light & Sound

- Examine your venue prior, establish issues such as movement during the presentation, light and sound. If the venue provides sound and light equipment, check it out.
- Test all microphones and ensure you are familiar with any ‘drop-out’ spots on stage.
- Assume nothing works until you’ve tested it, always be prepared with a ‘back-up’ mic.
- Many handheld microphones are unidirectional, meaning, they only pick up sound correctly from the front. Test the mic by talking into it close to your mouth and rotate it sideways to see if you can hear the difference. (Imagine the mic is a torch, the ray of light comes out from the top. It needs to look at you square in the face to work best)
- Hand held mics should be kept at about ‘sternum level’ and remember your body needs to move with your head if the mic is unidirectional. Practice this so you don’t get caught!

Light & Sound

- Walk the stage with the mic and get someone to listen at the back of the room. Don't just stand in the middle and go "testing 123" and walk off. Speak loud and soft, as you will during your presentation and check how it sounds. If you have a permanent 'sound guy' throughout your presentation. Let him/her know if there are any parts of your presentation that are exceptionally loud or quiet, give them the 'cue' so they know when it's coming and can make adjustments if necessary.
- When using the headset style microphones, again, check if it is unidirectional so you know how to position it near your face. Always make the mic box antennae (on your belt behind you) hang upside down so the aerial won't get bent.

- Make the seating/table layout such that you can engage with people, walk between them and test what it's like to work the stage without leaving your back to the remaining audience.
- When using overhead lighting, ensure it covers you, not the plants.
- Make sure you have front and rear lighting so you don't look 'over-shadowed' and never let the overhead lights blind the audience or yourself.

Our Notes

- Detail

Our Action Plan

Task	Whom	When